END-OF-COURSE PROJECT · MILESTONE 1

Project Problem Statement

Submit by the end of Week 3 [23 August 23:59 hrs]· ~1 page · individual · formative (not graded) — you'll get written feedback. This seeds your End-of-Course Project (it maps to Project Rubric criteria 1 & 2).

This submission is NOT graded. However, on time non-submission counts towards incomplete End of course project.

Name: Isha Kirti Ghia **Section (A / B / C):** B **Date:** 21-08-2026

1 · Working title

A short, specific name for your project.

Renewal Radar - flags contracts approaching their cancellation-notice deadline before auto-renewal locks the company in.

2 · The problem, and why it matters

Who has this problem, and why is it worth solving? 2–3 sentences. (Rubric 1)

Procurement and legal-ops teams manage dozens of vendor contracts, miss cancellation-notice windows because no one reviews every contract on a fixed schedule, and auto-renewal clauses silently extend deals the company meant to renegotiate or cancel.

3 · Who it's for, and the domain

Your user / audience and the industry (e.g. banking, healthcare, retail, your employer).

A procurement/legal-ops analyst managing roughly 150 active vendor contracts stored across a shared drive, who currently tracks renewal dates in a spreadsheet that is usually a few contracts out of date. Domain: legal operations / procurement.

4 · Why AI — and which kind? Remember, from class 1 workshops, no one size fits all

Is AI the right tool here (vs a rule or lookup)? If yes, which type — narrow ML, a foundation model, RAG, an agent? (ILO 1)

Yes, but only for one specific part. Contracts word their renewal and notice clauses very differently. A simple keyword search can miss a lot of them, that's my baseline, and I'll test how often it fails. For extraction, I'll prompt an existing LLM to pull out the clause. The date-comparison logic, "is today within the notice window?" stays a normal rule in my code, not AI.

5 · Proposed approach — build vs buy or both!

What will you build (low-code and/or code)? Which layers will you own vs rent, and why? (Rubric 2, ILO 3)

Rent: the LLM API for clause extraction. Own: the deterministic reminder/deadline logic, the confidence threshold for abstention, and the review interface (low code). I will try a keyword-search baseline first and report where it breaks before justifying the move to an LLM extraction layer.

6 · Data – this packs the intelligence !

What data do you need, where from, and any access / privacy / residency constraints?

I'm using CUAD, a public dataset of 510 real commercial contracts, originally SEC filings. It's free to use under a CC BY 4.0 licence. Of these, 178 contracts have a renewal-term or notice-period clause already labelled - that's my working dataset. I split it into 138 contracts to build and test my prompt on, and kept 40 aside that I won't look at until the very end. That way I can check my results honestly. Since these are public company filings, not personal information, there's no privacy issue here.

7 · Success metric & how you'll evaluate it

One metric that ties to real value, and one check (an eval) you could actually run. (evals thread)

I'll check how many of the 40 held-out contracts my system gets right. Did it correctly pull out the renewal date, the notice period, and whether the contract auto-renews? I'll compare this against a very basic guess,

like always saying "yes it auto-renews," to make sure my system adds real value. If the system isn't confident, it should say so instead of guessing and I'll also track how often that happens.

8 · Risks, limitations & responsible use

What could go wrong (incl. silent failure), and who might it affect?

The biggest risk is the system misreading a clause and not flagging it. The user wouldn't even know it happened, which is worse than an obvious error. To catch this, I'll set a confidence threshold, so uncertain cases always go to a person to check rather than getting marked safe automatically. This tool only reminds and flags, it will never cancel or renew a contract on its own. That decision always stays with a person.

9 · Smallest first version (optional)

The tiniest end-to-end slice you could build first.

I give it the text of one contract. It gives back three things - the renewal date, the notice deadline, and whether it auto-renews, or "not sure" if it can't tell.

How this is used

This milestone is not graded — it's to give you fast, written feedback while there's still time to change direction. A strong problem statement makes criteria 1 (problem & significance) and 2 (business & technical trade-offs) and helps you start on a strong footing. Bring questions during class breakouts or email the course account or WA text me

INSTRUCTOR FEEDBACK

For marker use — formative comments on the problem & significance (criterion 1) and the business/technical trade-offs (criterion 2), plus one thing to strengthen before the final project.